



MEAL ASSISTANCE REFERRAL PROGRAMME

PREAMBLE

- The Meal Assistance Programme has limited funds and can only support a limited number of students. Assistance is granted based on set criteria and subject to fund availability.
- Staff members, including psychologists, nurses, lecturers, and other relevant professionals, may refer students they identify as potentially needing meal assistance. However, the student must take responsibility for completing the application themselves.

REFERRAL PROCESS

- Staff members may refer students by providing a link to the official meal assistance application. It is the responsibility of the student to complete the application and submit the required supporting documents.
- Referrals should not bypass the application process. The onus is on the student to provide the necessary documentation proving financial need.
- If a student is unable, due to exceptional circumstances, to complete the application process (e.g., mental health issues or disability), the referring psychologist, social worker, or nurse must submit a formal report. This report should detail the student's situation and provide evidence of their financial need. The report will be considered as part of the selection committee's decision-making process.

CRITERIA FOR REFERRAL AND APPLICATION

In order to qualify for meal assistance through a referral, the student must meet the following criteria:

- Be registered at the University of Johannesburg.
- Not be receiving any meal assistance from another organization or division within the University.
- Demonstrate financial need, with the burden of proof lying on the student or, in exceptional cases, the referring staff member.

- The student's financial need must have a clear, demonstrable effect on their academic performance and overall wellbeing.
- All assistance is granted on a semester basis, and the duration of assistance is subject to the availability of funds.
- The student must achieve at least 60% of their registered modules to be considered for ongoing or future assistance.

STAFF MEMBER RESPONSIBILITY

- Referrals are intended to assist students in identifying the need for meal assistance, but do not guarantee approval.
 - It is important that staff members maintain professional boundaries, ensuring that students complete the application process themselves unless exceptional circumstances apply.